

the wind and take your counter bait. At this point, you can actually feed them misinformation on their own statements and in almost all cases, they will agree without delay. Make no mistake, this is also the point where the troll might prove to actually be someone who knows their way around what they are talking about, so be careful and cross check their repertoire first.

Traveller: Just got the best beach package for 20k.

Hereto Troll: Dude!!! You got ripped. That package comes for 15k!!! I took it a few weeks back!!!

Traveller: oh!! Damn.. hey can you tell me what did you get in your package?

Hereto Troll: Sure! I got the beach hut, the parasailing, the ATV rides, breakfast, lunch, dinner, the fort tour with guide, the trekking and a few other tidbits.

Traveller: Wow, Sure sounds good. And how many days did you stay?

Hereto Troll: About 10 days.

Traveller: Ok. Is the cellphone connectivity good there?

Hereto Troll: Yeah, sure is.

Traveller: Ok. seems like you had fun on your 13k package to this amazing place. Glad to know that.

Hereto Troll: Yeah. Sure did, all that for just 13k. Too bad you got ripped off.

Traveller: But you just said the package was for 15k. And now you are saying it's 13k.

Hereto Troll: oh...wait..

Traveller: And I just checked. There is no fort in the entire town. It's just there on the postcards.

Hereto Troll: Ttyl Bye!!

6 THOU SHALT BE SERIOUS

Sometimes, all it takes to drive the wind out of a joke are a few serious faces pretending to not understand it. The same logic applies to the online activities of a troll, even the ones that are trying too hard to feed you misinformation. Tell them you believe them, in fact pretend that you are taking serious action based on the information they gave you, even after they have declared all of it to be a trolling attempt. Trust me, this one works like magic!

Hereto Troll: Hey!!

Sirius Sam: Yes?

Hereto Troll: I just used your credit card to buy myself a new car!!!

Sirius Sam: What the....??

Hereto Troll: LOL!! You just got trolled!!

Sirius Sam: So it was you!

Hereto Troll: What? What do you mean?

Sirius Sam: My card did get stolen and I just received a purchase message from NewCar Dealers this morning!



The Golden rule to out-troll a troll

Hereto Troll: What are you talking about man??? I told you I was just kidding with you!!!

Sirius Sam: Wait I'm calling the cops!
Hereto Troll is offline

7 THOU SHALT UPHOLD THE TRUTH

Contrary to what we might hope from it, the world, both online and offline, does have the ability to spot an idiot when their actions are out in the open. Irrespective of whether you are following any of the previous points or not - always keep evidence. A troll, especially a seasoned one, is always ready to remove all traces of their activities and pretend as if nothing happened. Before that can happen, take your screenshots and video captures. And when the time is right, hail the admins! Any online community usually has guidelines to follow and takes their violations seriously.

8 THOU SHALT FIND THE ENEMY OF YOUR ENEMY

A troll enjoys the game too much to stop after one successful trolling. Chances are, your troll has trolled someone earlier and is probably trolling multiple people when you got trolled. Talk to the others who have been victims of your troll's activities. Once you are ready with a plan, lay the trap, gather the numbers, and wait for the troll to walk right into your hungry, bloodthirsty crowd. Once he's in and trolling - Charge!

Jane Doe: I just got another reeeeeeeeee!!!!-lyyyy cuuutee teddy!!

Hereto Troll: Again!!!!!! You just proved you are full!!!! reetarded!!!! This one's even lamer!!

Jane Doe: Hey.. It's you again! Didn't you ever have a favorite soft toy?

Hereto Troll: Nope!! My favorite toy was a limited edition Ultra Ninja Swordmaster figurine.

Goodguy Gamer: I believe there are only 3 of those, and currently all three are with the International Game Museum.

Hereto Troll: What? What are you doin here?

Herr Punctuator: *doing

Hereto Troll: What the...

Traveller: So did you get the figurine for 15k or 13k? :P

Hereto Troll: Damn you all! M gonna kill you all!

Sirius Sam: Don't worry guys. Police is on its way to his place.

Hereto Troll deactivated account

9 THOU SHALT RELY ON SHADOWBANNING

Several online communities have mechanisms in place to ban a troll/harmful person in such a way that their comments are only visible to themselves. That way, they don't get to figure out that they are banned until quite a while, and once they do, there's pretty much nothing they can do about it. Consider this the conceptual opposite of doxxing, where you actually reveal the identity of an anonymous person, here